

Day 46 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Education and Health Systems in Tamil Nadu, and e-Governance in Tamil Nadu

READING MATERIAL

Covers Tamil Nadu's education reforms (Samacheer Kalvi), its historic public health leadership, and 3 real exam hits on e-Governance initiatives (E-Sevai centers, the Government e-Marketplace, and the 'Neengal Nalama' scheme).

Q: What is Samacheer Kalvi, and when was it introduced?

A: Samacheer Kalvi ('Uniform System of School Education') was introduced in Tamil Nadu in 2010-11, establishing a standardised curriculum across all school boards (State Board, Matriculation, Anglo-Indian) for classes 1 to 12, aimed at ensuring educational equity regardless of which board a student's school followed.

Q: What historic distinction does Tamil Nadu hold in public health legislation?

A: Tamil Nadu was the FIRST Indian state to enact a Public Health Act, in 1939 — reflecting a long-standing tradition of strong political commitment to public health infrastructure at the district level.

Q: Real exam: What is the primary function of TN's E-Sevai centers, per a real exam passage?

A: To facilitate the online delivery of essential government services — confirmed as the correct inference from a real exam's reading-comprehension-style passage about E-Sevai centers.

Q: Real exam: Which statements about the Government e-Marketplace (GeM) are TRUE, and what is the trap?

A: TRUE: India's public procurement reaches roughly 20-25% of GDP, and GeM was conceptualised as a Special Purpose Vehicle (SPV) for government procurement. The TRAP: GeM was NOT set up in August 2006 — its actual launch was in August 2016; a real exam tested this wrong year as part of a 'choose the correct statements' question.

Q: Real exam: What is 'Neengal Nalama', and what does it involve?

A: A Tamil Nadu Government scheme that is (per a real exam, confirming ALL of the following as true): intended to reduce the gap between people and the Government, an instrument of e-governance, and focused on ensuring government initiatives actually reach their intended beneficiaries.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Samacheer Kalvi, Tamil Nadu's uniform school education system, was introduced in:

- A. 2005-06
- B. 2010-11 ✓**
- C. 2015-16
- D. 2020-21

Explanation: 2010-11. [medium, web-research]

2. Which Indian state was the FIRST to enact a Public Health Act, in 1939?

- A. Kerala
- B. Tamil Nadu ✓**
- C. Maharashtra
- D. West Bengal

Explanation: Tamil Nadu. [medium, web-research]

3. What is the primary function of Tamil Nadu's E-Sevai centers?

- A. To train government employees
- B. To facilitate online delivery of essential government services ✓**
- C. To manage state-level databases only
- D. To monitor rural population growth

Explanation: Facilitate online delivery of essential government services. [medium, question-bank-2025]

4. The Government e-Marketplace (GeM) was actually launched in which year (not 2006, a common trap)?

- A. 2010

- B. 2014
- C. 2016 ✓**
- D. 2019

Explanation: 2016 (a real exam tested 2006 as a wrong distractor). [hard, question-bank-2026]

5. Approximately what percentage of India's GDP does public procurement reach, per a real exam fact?

- A. 5-10%
- B. 20-25% ✓**
- C. 40-45%
- D. 60-65%

Explanation: 20-25%. [medium, question-bank-2026]

6. GeM (Government e-Marketplace) was conceptualised as a:

- A. Joint venture company
- B. Special Purpose Vehicle (SPV) ✓**
- C. Private limited startup
- D. Foreign-funded NGO

Explanation: Special Purpose Vehicle. [medium, question-bank-2026]

7. 'Neengal Nalama', a Tamil Nadu Government scheme, involves which of the following?

- A. Reducing the gap between people and Government only
- B. Being an instrument of e-governance only
- C. Ensuring government initiatives reach intended beneficiaries only
- D. All of the above ✓**

Explanation: All of the above. [medium, question-bank-2025]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Visual Reasoning

READING MATERIAL

Visual Reasoning is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills, testing image-based logic rather than text/number puzzles — mirror images, water images, and embedded figures are the standard formats. Note: TNPSC's own answer key has at least one acknowledged disputed mirror-image question, a useful reminder that on visual questions specifically, double-check your own reasoning rather than assuming the 'obvious' answer is automatically right.

Q: What is the rule for a MIRROR image, and what stays the same vs. flips?

A: A mirror image flips LEFT and RIGHT (the right side of the object appears on the left, and vice versa), while TOP and BOTTOM stay the same. Imagine holding the figure up to a vertical mirror.

Q: What is the rule for a WATER image, and how is it different from a mirror image?

A: A water image flips TOP and BOTTOM (it appears upside-down, as if reflected in still water below the object), while LEFT and RIGHT stay the same. This is the opposite axis of flipping compared to a mirror image.

Q: What is the best strategy for solving mirror/water image questions quickly?

A: Focus on the most unique or asymmetric part of the figure first (not the symmetric parts, which look the same either way) — mentally flip just that distinctive part along the correct axis (vertical line for mirror, horizontal line for water), and use it to eliminate options before checking the rest.

Q: What is an 'embedded figure' question, and what does it test?

A: A question where a simple shape is hidden within a more complex, cluttered figure, and you must identify which of the answer-choice shapes appears embedded within it. Tests visual scanning and pattern-matching rather than flipping/rotation.

Q: Real exam (flagged as disputed by TNPSC itself): A figure is shown, and you must choose its correct mirror image from 4 options.

What's the most reliable way to verify your choice, given that even the official answer key has had disputed cases here?

A: Don't just eyeball it — explicitly trace which side each distinctive feature should land on after a left-right flip, point by point, rather than relying on a quick visual impression. Given that TNPSC's own committee has had to review at least one mirror-image answer, treat your worked-through reasoning as more trustworthy than a snap visual judgment, and double-check rather than rushing.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. In a MIRROR image of a figure, which pair of sides swap?

- A. Top and bottom
- B. Left and right ✓**
- C. Diagonal corners only
- D. Nothing swaps

Explanation: Left and right swap; top and bottom stay the same. [easy, web-research]

2. In a WATER image of a figure, which pair of sides swap?

- A. Top and bottom ✓**
- B. Left and right
- C. Both pairs swap
- D. Neither swaps

Explanation: Top and bottom swap; left and right stay the same. [easy, web-research]

3. The letter 'b' would appear as which letter in its mirror image (left-right flip)?

- A. b
- B. d ✓**
- C. p
- D. q

Explanation: 'b' has its stem on the left with the bowl attached at bottom-right. Flipping left-right moves the stem to the right with the bowl at bottom-left — that's the letter 'd'. [medium, authored]

4. The letter 'b' would appear as which letter in its water image (top-bottom flip)?

- A. b
- B. d

C. p ✓

D. q

Explanation: Flipping 'b' top-to-bottom keeps the stem on the left but moves the bowl from bottom-right to top-right — that's the letter 'p'. (Mirror and water images of the same letter generally differ — here mirror gives 'd', water gives 'p'.) [hard, authored]

5. An 'embedded figure' question primarily tests:

A. Arithmetic ability

B. Visual scanning and pattern-matching within a cluttered figure ✓

C. Vocabulary

D. Memory of a list

Explanation: Visual scanning/pattern-matching to find a hidden shape within a complex figure. [medium, web-research]

Part C – General English: Prose: "Sea Turtles" — Shekar Dattatri

READING MATERIAL

An informational nature-conservation prose by wildlife filmmaker Shekar Dattatri about sea turtle biology, their incredible survival odds, and the human-caused threats endangering them today.

Q: What kind of animal is a sea turtle, and what is the average weight of a sea turtle hatchling?

A: A sea turtle is a REPTILE. A hatchling weighs about 20 grams on average.

Q: What often happens to hatchlings before they even reach the sea, and what are the survival odds from hatchling to adult?

A: Many hatchlings are caught by birds or crabs before reaching the sea. Only about 1 IN 1000 hatchlings survives to grow into an adult sea turtle.

Q: Why do sea turtles lay so many eggs, given such low survival odds?

A: To increase their overall chances of survival — laying a large number of eggs compensates for the very high mortality rate among hatchlings.

Q: Where do female sea turtles return to lay their eggs, and what makes this behaviour especially fascinating?

A: They return to the SAME BEACH where they themselves were born, often after years away at sea — their mysterious ability to navigate back to their exact nesting beach is what makes them especially fascinating.

Q: How long have sea turtles survived as a species, and what is the CURRENT main threat to them?

A: Millions of years. The current main threat is HUMAN ACTIVITIES.

Q: What do humans hunt sea turtles for, and what are two other human-caused dangers mentioned?

A: Humans hunt them for their MEAT AND EGGS. Other dangers include getting accidentally caught in motorboat nets, and ocean pollution caused by plastic dumping.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. What type of animal is a sea turtle?

- A. Amphibian
- B. Mammal
- C. Reptile ✓**
- D. Fish

Explanation: Reptile. [easy, web-research]

2. What is the average weight of a sea turtle hatchling?

- A. 10 grams
- B. 20 grams ✓**
- C. 30 grams
- D. 50 grams

Explanation: 20 grams. [medium, web-research]

3. What often happens to hatchlings before they reach the sea?

- A. They fly away
- B. They sleep
- C. They are caught by birds or crabs ✓**
- D. They go missing

Explanation: They are caught by birds or crabs. [medium, web-research]

4. Approximately how many hatchlings grow into adult sea turtles?

- A. 1 in 100
- B. 1 in 1000 ✓**
- C. 1 in 10
- D. 1 in 500

Explanation: 1 in 1000. [hard, web-research]

5. Why do sea turtles lay many eggs?

A. For food

B. For fun

C. To increase survival chances ✓

D. To pollute beaches

Explanation: To increase survival chances. [medium, web-research]

6. Where do female sea turtles return to lay their eggs?

A. Any beach

B. The same beach where they were born ✓

C. A rocky beach

D. Nearby rivers

Explanation: The same beach where they were born. [medium, web-research]

7. How long have sea turtles survived as a species?

A. Thousands of years

B. Decades

C. Hundreds of years

D. Millions of years ✓

Explanation: Millions of years. [medium, web-research]

8. What is the current main threat to sea turtles?

A. Cold weather

B. Earthquakes

C. Human activities ✓

D. Birds

Explanation: Human activities. [easy, web-research]

9. What do humans primarily hunt sea turtles for?

A. Scales

B. Toys

C. Meat and eggs ✓

D. Feathers

Explanation: Meat and eggs. [medium, web-research]

10. What is one major cause of sea pollution affecting turtles, per the passage?

A. Rain

B. Soil

C. Plastic dumping ✓

D. Trees

Explanation: Plastic dumping. [easy, web-research]